



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 24 MAY 2026 - 30 MAY 2026

POLESTAR-ADVISORY.COM

DATA STATUS: MIXED SOURCES (LIVE, MANUAL & STATIC) LATEST RECORD: 21 MAY 2026 LAST UPDATED: 23 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Papua New Guinea is a low-volume but high-friction operating environment. No relevant incidents were recorded in the 7-day window. Urban violent crime in Port Moresby and Lae, route security, Highlands instability and resource-sector exposure remain the standing operating risks; these are carried in the 30-day and 90-day context sections below as background pattern, not as fresh weekly activity. Reporting volume on PNG is genuinely thin most weeks, so a zero weekly count should be read as a coverage gap rather than calm.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 24 May - 30 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 0 No records in the weekly window	HIGHEST SEVERITY —
MOST AFFECTED AREA —	LATEST INCIDENT —	MAIN ISSUE TYPE —

SITUATION

Papua New Guinea is shaped by urban opportunistic crime in Port Moresby and Lae, inter-clan violence in the highlands, recurring resource-sector disputes and severe interior infrastructure limits — these are the standing operating picture, not this week's events. No relevant incidents were recorded in the 7-day window; treat the silence as a reporting-coverage feature of PNG rather than a clean operating picture. The named risks above and anything older than seven days sit in the 30 / 90-day context sections below and should not be read as current activity.

WHAT HAPPENED

Nothing fresh landed in the current 7-day window. The 30-day and 90-day context sections below carry the wider pattern — including any election-cycle unrest, fuel or port disruption, and Madang / Lae corridor incidents — but those are background, not current activity. Treat them as standing-risk reference, not as something that happened this week.

WHAT MATTERS

The absence of records does not mean an absence of activity. Source coverage in this window was thin, so any forward read should treat the operating picture as unconfirmed rather than calm.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Review movement plans for Port Moresby and Lae and refresh pre-movement briefings on the current incident types.
- Avoid predictable travel patterns around cash-handling sites, ATMs and end-of-shift cash runs.
- Check local security support is in place for any commercial site visit, including arrival / departure windows.
- Confirm journey management for staff and contractors, with a named on-call contact and a clear escalation path.
- Review road movement assumptions outside the main urban areas; default to air where the Highlands Highway is in play.
- Maintain flexible routing and a tolerance for delay; closures and protests can land at short notice.
- Confirm medical and evacuation arrangements for remote work, including the Cairns / Brisbane / Singapore medevac chain.

LOCATION WATCHLIST

LOCATION	NOTE	7D	30D	90D	WORST (90D)
Port Moresby	National Capital District, settlement-area crime focus	0	11	19	HIGH
Lae	Morobe province, port and Highlands Highway head	0	7	13	HIGH
Mount Hagen	Western Highlands, tribal-fight focal point	0	1	5	HIGH
Enga / Porgera	Tribal violence, Barrick / Zijin Porgera mine	0	1	4	EXTREME
Hela / PNG LNG	ExxonMobil PNG LNG upstream, landowner disputes	0	4	5	HIGH
Southern Highlands	Tribal fights, fuel-tanker ambush corridor	0	0	1	MODERATE
Bougainville	Post-referendum political transition	0	0	1	LOW
Highlands Highway	Ambush corridor between Lae and resource provinces	0	2	6	EXTREME
Lihir / Newmont Lihir	Lihir Island gold operation	0	0	0	No records
Ok Tedi	Western Province copper-gold mine	0	0	0	No records

30-DAY CONTEXT

Across the rolling 30-day context window Papua New Guinea carries 30 records, with 30 records sitting outside the current 7-day cycle.

BACKGROUND OPERATING PICTURE

Across the rolling 90-day background window Papua New Guinea carries 60 records, 30 of which sit beyond the 30-day context. Use them to size the background operating picture rather than to direct current movement decisions.

MAP



● Extreme ● High ● Moderate ● Low ● Insignificant Leaflet | (c) OpenStreetMap (c) CARTO

Records without coordinates are included in totals and tables but not plotted on the map.

The map reflects current-window records only (0 records across the 7-day cycle). It is not the full risk picture — read it alongside the 30 / 90-day context sections above.

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION

No incidents in the weekly window to chart.

INCIDENT BREAKDOWN BY TYPE

No classifiable incident types in the weekly window.

WATCH NEXT

- Repeat armed-robbery or violent-crime activity in Port Moresby or Lae.
- Copycat or cluster activity around commercial premises, banks and cash-handling sites.
- Police response, arrests or any visible RPNGC posture change in the affected districts.
- Movement disruption near markets, main roads or cash-handling points in the two cities.
- Any shift from urban opportunistic crime to route or corridor incidents.
- Highlands Highway or Lae corridor deterioration — ambush, landslide, tribal-fight closure or strike action.
- Fuel, port or road disruption surfacing in the 30-day context that could spill into the current cycle.

POLESTAR VIEW

PNG should be treated as a low-volume but high-friction operating environment. A quiet week does not equal low risk. No relevant incidents were recorded in the 7-day window; the standing concerns — urban violent crime in Port Moresby and Lae, route security, Highlands instability and resource-sector exposure — sit in the 30 / 90-day context as background pattern, not current activity. Business users should focus on movement discipline, local security support, and clear escalation triggers for any staff or contractor travel.

RELATED INCIDENTS

No related incidents recorded for Papua New Guinea in the weekly window.

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